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PROJECT REPORT

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Project Domain: ServiceNow / IT Service Management

Technology: ServiceNow Flow Designer

Academic / Training Project

This report documents the problem, objective, workflow design, implementation steps, and expected outcome of an automated standard-laptop procurement task in ServiceNow.

PROJECT OVERVIEW

This project demonstrates how ServiceNow Flow Designer can automate a routine IT procurement activity. When a standard laptop is requested through the Service Catalog and the request reaches the required approval state, the flow creates a Catalog Task for the Hardware team and provides a consistent description for laptop configuration.

Project Title / Detail	Value
Project Title	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Platform	ServiceNow
Module	Flow Designer
Trigger	Service Catalog
Primary Action	Create Catalog Task
Assignment Group	Hardware
Task Description	Laptop need to be Configured
Approval	Approved

1. PROBLEM STATEMENT

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

2. USER STORY

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimizing manual intervention.

3. PROJECT OBJECTIVE

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilization within the IT department by optimizing task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

4. WORKFLOW DESIGN

The workflow uses a trigger-and-action pattern. The Service Catalog trigger starts the flow, and the Create Catalog Task action creates a task using the Requested Item Record and sends it to the Hardware assignment group.

Stage	Configuration
Trigger	Service Catalog
Data	Requested Item Record
Action	Create Catalog Task
Request Item	Requested Item Record
Table	Catalog Task
Short Description	Laptop need to be Configured
Description	Laptop need to be Configured
Assignment Group	Hardware
Approval	Approved

Workflow sequence

Service Catalog request → Requested Item Record → Create Catalog Task → Populate task details → Assign to Hardware → Task available for laptop configuration

5. TASK INITIATION - MILESTONE 1

Activity 1: Create a Flow to create a Catalog Task, update the short description after approval of the service request, and assign the task to the Hardware group.

Implementation Steps

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click All and search for Flow Designer.
3. Click Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer, click New and select Flow.
5. Under Flow Properties, give the Flow Name as Standard laptop tasks.
6. Set the Application to Global.
7. Select System user as the Run As user.
8. Click Submit and then click Add a trigger.
9. Search for Service Catalog and select it as the trigger.
10. Click Done.
11. Under Actions, click Add an Action.
12. Search for Create Catalog Task and select the action.
13. Set the action as Create Catalog Task.
14. Drag and drop Requested Item Record into the Request item field.
15. The Table field should be populated automatically as Catalog Task.
16. Set the Short Description to Laptop need to be Configured.
17. Click Add field value.
18. Select the Description field and enter Laptop need to be Configured.
19. Select the Assignment group field and choose Hardware.
20. Select the Approval field and choose Approved.
21. Leave the remaining fields at their default values and click Done.
22. Click Save to save the flow.
23. Click Activate, and click Activate again to confirm.

6. IMPLEMENTATION SCREENSHOT

The following screenshot shows the configured ServiceNow Workflow Studio / Flow Designer screen. It displays the Service Catalog trigger and the Create Catalog Task action.

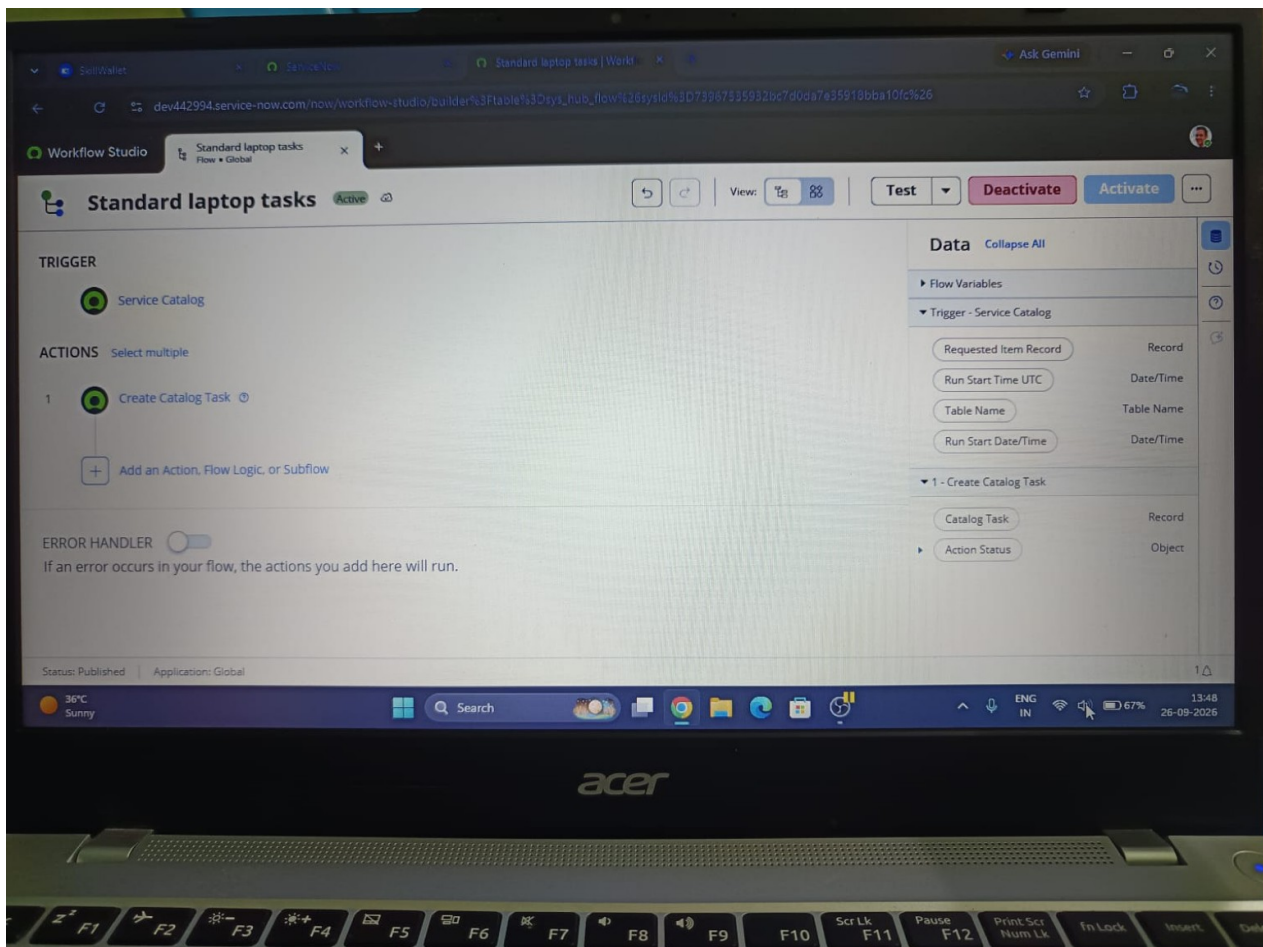


Figure 1: ServiceNow Flow Designer – Standard laptop tasks flow.

7. ACTION CONFIGURATION DETAILS

The Create Catalog Task action is the core automation step. The requested item record is passed into the action so the newly created task is associated with the original request. The task is then populated with standardized values.

Key field configuration

Field	Value
Request item	Requested Item Record
Table	Catalog Task
Short description	Laptop need to be Configured
Description	Laptop need to be Configured
Assignment group	Hardware
Approval	Approved

8. EXPECTED OUTPUT

After the flow is activated and the relevant service request reaches the configured approval state, a Catalog Task is automatically created. The task contains the standard laptop configuration description and is assigned to the Hardware group.

Expected result:

A standard laptop request produces a clearly identified Hardware task with the description “Laptop need to be Configured”, approval value Approved, and the appropriate assignment group.

9. ADVANTAGES

1. Automation of repetitive Catalog Task creation.
2. Faster hand-off from procurement/request processing to the Hardware team.
3. Consistent task descriptions and field values.
4. Reduced risk of manual omission or incorrect assignment.
5. Better visibility of configuration work through ServiceNow task records.
6. Improved utilization of IT support resources.
7. More predictable and standardized laptop provisioning workflow.

10. APPLICATIONS

1. Standard laptop and desktop procurement workflows.
2. Employee onboarding and device provisioning.
3. IT asset preparation and configuration.
4. Hardware replacement and refresh processes.
5. Service Catalog requests requiring specialized team tasks.

11. FUTURE ENHANCEMENTS

1. Add automated notifications to the requester and Hardware team when the task is created.
2. Use additional conditions to distinguish standard, high-performance, and special-purpose laptop requests.
3. Automatically populate configuration information such as model, asset type, location, or delivery details.
4. Add approval checks and exception handling for incomplete requests.
5. Integrate inventory availability so the flow can check stock before creating the configuration task.
6. Add reporting and dashboards to measure task completion time and procurement efficiency.

12. CONCLUSION

The Standard Laptop Tasks project demonstrates a practical use of ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate an important IT procurement activity. By using a Service Catalog trigger and a Create Catalog Task action, the process can consistently create and assign a Hardware task with the required information. This reduces repetitive manual work, improves task hand-off, and supports a more efficient laptop configuration process.

The project also provides a foundation for further automation, such as notifications, inventory validation, approvals, exception handling, and performance reporting. Overall, the workflow shows how low-code automation can be applied to improve everyday IT service operations.

13. PROJECT SUMMARY

Item	Summary
Problem	Manual and delayed standard laptop configuration task handling.
Solution	ServiceNow Flow Designer automation.
Trigger	Service Catalog.
Action	Create Catalog Task.
Team	Hardware.
Task	Laptop need to be Configured.
Approval	Approved.
Outcome	Consistent and automated task creation for laptop configuration.